GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

ANTI-BRIBERY POLICY

Document Information	
Policy Name	Anti-Bribery Policy
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Anti-Money Laundering Policy, Conflict of Interest Policy, Whistleblowing Policy, Due Diligence Policy

1. Introduction and Purpose

1.1 Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation registered in England, established to prevent and relieve poverty and financial hardship in Gloucestershire and the wider United Kingdom, with a particular focus on members of the Muslim community.

As a charity entrusted with public donations, including Zakat (obligatory Islamic almsgiving) and Sadaqah (voluntary charity), we have a duty to ensure that all funds are used solely for legitimate charitable purposes and that our activities are conducted with the highest standards of integrity.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose of this Anti-Bribery Policy is to:

- Set out the Charity's commitment to preventing bribery and corruption in all its forms
- Ensure compliance with the UK Bribery Act 2010 and Charity Commission regulatory guidance
- Protect the Charity's reputation and the trust placed in us by donors, beneficiaries, and the public
- Provide clear guidance to all trustees, volunteers, and associates on expected standards of conduct
- Establish procedures for identifying, reporting, and addressing bribery risks

1.3 Legal Context

The UK Bribery Act 2010 creates four criminal offences:

- Bribing another person (Section 1) – offering, promising, or giving a bribe
- Being bribed (Section 2) – requesting, agreeing to receive, or accepting a bribe
- Bribing a foreign public official (Section 6) – to obtain or retain business
- Failure to prevent bribery (Section 7) – corporate offence where an organisation fails to prevent bribery

Individuals found guilty of bribery offences can face up to 10 years' imprisonment and unlimited fines. Organisations can face unlimited fines and reputational damage.

The Charity Commission requires charities to have adequate procedures in place to prevent bribery and corruption, and to report any serious incidents involving financial crime.

2. Scope

2.1 Who This Policy Applies To

This policy applies to:

- All trustees of the Charity
- All volunteers working on behalf of the Charity
- Any contractors or consultants engaged by the Charity
- Partner organisations acting on the Charity's behalf
- Any other person or organisation representing the Charity

2.2 Activities Covered

This policy covers all activities undertaken in connection with the Charity, including but not limited to:

- Grant-making decisions and beneficiary selection
- Procurement of goods and services
- Relationships with partner organisations (such as GARAS, GMWA, GIT, and GBA)
- Fundraising activities and donor relationships
- Educational workshops and community outreach
- Any dealings with public officials, local authorities, or regulatory bodies

2.3 Geographic Scope

This policy applies to all activities conducted by or on behalf of the Charity within the United Kingdom.

3. Policy Statement

Gloucester Zakat Charity is committed to:

- Conducting all activities with integrity, honesty, and transparency
- Ensuring that all charitable funds—whether Zakat, Sadaqah, or other donations—are used solely for legitimate charitable purposes
- Maintaining zero tolerance for bribery and corruption in any form
- Upholding the trust placed in us by donors, beneficiaries, partner organisations, and the public
- Complying fully with the UK Bribery Act 2010 and all applicable anti-corruption laws
- Taking appropriate action against anyone who breaches this policy

The Charity recognises that as stewards of charitable funds, particularly religious obligations such as Zakat, we bear a sacred trust that demands the highest ethical standards.

4. Definitions

For the purposes of this policy:

Bribery means offering, promising, giving, requesting, agreeing to receive, or accepting a financial or other advantage with the intention of inducing or rewarding improper performance of a function or activity.

Corruption means the abuse of entrusted power for private gain, including but not limited to bribery, fraud, extortion, and conflicts of interest.

Facilitation payment means a small unofficial payment made to secure or expedite a routine or necessary action (such payments are illegal under UK law).

Public official means any person holding a legislative, administrative, or judicial position, or exercising a public function.

Associated person means any person or organisation performing services for or on behalf of the Charity, including trustees, volunteers, contractors, and partner organisations.

Gift means anything of value given without expectation of payment or return, including cash, vouchers, goods, services, or other benefits.

Hospitality means entertainment, meals, accommodation, travel, or other similar benefits provided or received in connection with the Charity's activities.

5. Prohibited Conduct

5.1 Strictly Prohibited Activities

The following conduct is strictly prohibited and will not be tolerated under any circumstances:

5.1.1 Bribery

- Offering, promising, or giving any bribe or improper inducement to any person
- Requesting, agreeing to receive, or accepting any bribe or improper inducement
- Making any payment or providing any benefit to improperly influence grant decisions, procurement choices, or any other Charity activity

5.1.2 Facilitation Payments

- Making any facilitation payments, regardless of local custom or pressure
- This includes small payments to expedite routine actions such as processing applications, obtaining permits, or securing services

5.1.3 Improper Influence in Grant-Making

- Accepting any payment, gift, or benefit in exchange for approving a grant application
- Giving preferential treatment to applicants based on personal relationships, gifts received, or other improper considerations
- Manipulating the grant assessment process for personal gain or to benefit associates

5.1.4 Concealment

- Failing to disclose any actual or suspected bribery or corruption
- Destroying, concealing, or falsifying records relating to potential bribery
- Assisting others to conceal bribery or corrupt activities

5.1.5 Retaliation

- Retaliating or threatening retaliation against anyone who reports suspected bribery or corruption in good faith
- Victimising anyone who refuses to participate in bribery or corruption

5.2 Examples of Prohibited Conduct

To provide clarity, the following examples illustrate prohibited conduct relevant to our operations:

Scenario	Why It Is Prohibited
A grant applicant offers a trustee £50 "as a thank you" before their application is decided	This could constitute a bribe to influence the grant decision
A trustee accepts tickets to a football match from a supplier hoping to secure a contract	This could be an improper inducement to favour that supplier
A volunteer accepts cash to prioritise a particular family's application	This is accepting a bribe to improperly perform their function
A trustee pays a "processing fee" to a council officer to speed up a funding application	This is a facilitation payment and is illegal
A partner organisation offers to include a trustee's relative in their programme in exchange for referrals	This could be an improper inducement involving a conflict of interest

6. Gifts, Hospitality, and Donations

6.1 General Principles

The Charity recognises that modest gifts and hospitality can be a normal part of building relationships with partner organisations, donors, and the community. However, these must never compromise—or appear to compromise—the integrity of the Charity or its decision-making.

6.2 Gifts and Hospitality – Receiving

6.2.1 Permitted

- Token gifts of nominal value (under £25) such as calendars, pens, or branded items
- Modest hospitality such as refreshments at meetings or working lunches
- Cultural or religious gifts given as part of community customs (e.g., Eid gifts) of nominal value

6.2.2 Requires Approval

- Any gift or hospitality with a value between £25 and £100 must be reported to the Chair and recorded in the Gifts and Hospitality Register
- Any gift or hospitality with a value over £100 must be approved by the Board of Trustees before acceptance

6.2.3 Prohibited

- Cash or cash equivalents (vouchers, gift cards) of any value
- Gifts or hospitality that could reasonably be seen as intended to influence a decision
- Gifts or hospitality from grant applicants while their application is pending
- Any gift or hospitality that is lavish, excessive, or inappropriate
- Gifts or hospitality offered in secret or with a request for confidentiality

6.3 Gifts and Hospitality – Giving

Any gifts or hospitality given on behalf of the Charity must:

- Be modest, reasonable, and proportionate
- Have a legitimate charitable or relationship-building purpose
- Be approved by the Chair or Board of Trustees in advance
- Be recorded in the Gifts and Hospitality Register
- Not be given to public officials or anyone in a position to influence decisions affecting the Charity

6.4 Donations to the Charity

The Charity must not accept donations:

- From sources known or reasonably suspected to be involved in bribery, corruption, or other criminal activity
- With conditions that could compromise the Charity's independence or integrity
- That are offered as an inducement for the Charity to act improperly

Where there are concerns about the source or conditions of a donation, the matter must be referred to the Board of Trustees. See the Anti-Money Laundering Policy and Due Diligence Policy for further guidance.

6.5 Gifts and Hospitality Register

The Charity shall maintain a Gifts and Hospitality Register recording:

- Date of gift/hospitality
- Description and estimated value
- Name of giver/recipient
- Reason for giving/receiving
- Approval obtained (if required)

This register shall be reviewed by the Board of Trustees at least annually.

7. Due Diligence

7.1 Partner Organisations

Before entering into formal partnerships or Memoranda of Understanding with organisations such as GARAS, GMWA, GIT, GBA, or others, the Charity will conduct proportionate due diligence to satisfy itself that the partner:

- Is a legitimate organisation with a good reputation
- Has appropriate anti-bribery and anti-corruption policies in place
- Is not involved in any activities that could expose the Charity to bribery or corruption risks

7.2 Contractors and Suppliers

When engaging contractors or suppliers, the Charity will:

- Select suppliers based on merit, quality, and value for money—not personal relationships or inducements
- Conduct proportionate due diligence on suppliers for contracts over £500
- Include anti-bribery provisions in contracts where appropriate
- Monitor supplier relationships for any indication of corrupt practices

7.3 Grant Recipients

The Charity's grant-making due diligence includes consideration of whether:

- The applicant or their associates are involved in any criminal activity
- The grant could be diverted for improper purposes
- There are any conflicts of interest affecting the grant decision

8. Roles and Responsibilities

8.1 Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees is collectively responsible for:

- Approving and reviewing this policy
- Setting the tone from the top by demonstrating commitment to ethical conduct
- Ensuring adequate procedures are in place to prevent bribery
- Reviewing the Gifts and Hospitality Register annually
- Investigating any reported concerns and taking appropriate action
- Reporting serious incidents to the Charity Commission as required

8.2 Chair of Trustees

The Chair has particular responsibility for:

- Acting as the primary point of contact for reporting concerns under this policy
- Approving gifts and hospitality between £25 and £100
- Escalating serious concerns to the full Board
- Ensuring new trustees and volunteers are made aware of this policy

8.3 All Trustees

Each trustee is responsible for:

- Reading, understanding, and complying with this policy

- Declaring any conflicts of interest that could affect their judgment
- Reporting any concerns about potential bribery or corruption
- Exercising vigilance in grant-making and other decisions
- Refusing any improper inducement and reporting the approach

8.4 Volunteers

All volunteers must:

- Comply with this policy in all activities undertaken for the Charity
- Report any concerns about potential bribery or corruption to a trustee
- Refuse any improper inducement and report the approach
- Seek guidance if uncertain whether conduct may breach this policy

9. Reporting Concerns

9.1 How to Report

Anyone who suspects or becomes aware of bribery or corruption must report it immediately. Reports can be made to:

- The Chair of Trustees (Mr Abdullah Patel)
- Any other trustee if the concern involves the Chair
- Externally, if internal reporting is not appropriate (see section 9.3)

Reports can be made verbally or in writing (including by email). The Charity encourages reporting and will support anyone who raises concerns in good faith.

9.2 What to Report

Reports should include (where known):

- Description of the suspected bribery or corruption
- Names of individuals or organisations involved
- Dates, locations, and any other relevant details
- Any documentary evidence available
- Whether the matter has been reported elsewhere

9.3 External Reporting

In serious cases, or where internal reporting is not appropriate, concerns may be reported to:

- Charity Commission: Via the serious incident reporting process
- Police: For suspected criminal offences
- Action Fraud: The UK's national fraud reporting centre (0300 123 2040)

Individuals may also have protections under the Public Interest Disclosure Act 1998 (whistleblowing legislation).

9.4 Confidentiality and Protection

The Charity will:

- Treat all reports confidentially to the extent possible
- Not tolerate any retaliation against anyone who reports concerns in good faith
- Take appropriate action against anyone who retaliates against a reporter

- Support individuals who raise concerns, even if the concerns prove unfounded (provided they were raised in good faith)

See also the Whistleblowing Policy for further details on raising concerns.

10. Responding to Bribery or Corruption

10.1 Investigation

All reports of suspected bribery or corruption will be investigated promptly and thoroughly. The Board of Trustees will:

- Appoint appropriate persons to conduct the investigation (which may include external advisers)
- Ensure the investigation is fair and proportionate
- Document the investigation process and findings
- Maintain confidentiality to the extent possible

10.2 Outcomes

If bribery or corruption is substantiated, the Charity may take the following actions:

Person Involved	Possible Actions
Trustee	Removal from the Board; reporting to Charity Commission; referral to police
Volunteer	Termination of volunteer relationship; referral to police if appropriate
Contractor/Supplier	Termination of contract; recovery of funds; referral to police
Partner Organisation	Termination of partnership; recovery of funds; referral to police
Grant Applicant/Recipient	Rejection of application; recovery of grant; referral to police

10.3 Reporting to Authorities

The Charity will report serious incidents involving bribery or corruption to:

- The Charity Commission (as a serious incident)
- The police (where criminal offences are suspected)
- Other relevant authorities as appropriate

11. Training and Awareness

11.1 Trustee Induction

All new trustees will:

- Receive a copy of this policy as part of their induction
- Be briefed on their responsibilities under the UK Bribery Act 2010
- Acknowledge in writing that they have read and understood this policy

11.2 Volunteer Awareness

Volunteers involved in grant-making, procurement, or partner relationships will be made aware of:

- The key principles of this policy
- The importance of reporting any concerns
- How to seek guidance if uncertain

11.3 Ongoing Awareness

The Board of Trustees will ensure that anti-bribery awareness is maintained through:

- Annual review of this policy at a Board meeting
- Discussion of any relevant incidents or near-misses
- Updates on any changes to legislation or guidance

12. Record Keeping

The Charity will maintain the following records relevant to this policy:

Record	Retention Period
Gifts and Hospitality Register	6 years
Due diligence records for partners and suppliers	6 years after relationship ends
Reports of suspected bribery and investigation records	6 years (or longer if legal proceedings)
Training and acknowledgement records	Duration of relationship + 6 years

13. Review

This policy will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees every two years, or sooner if:

- There are significant changes to legislation or regulatory guidance
- A serious incident occurs that highlights gaps in the policy
- There are significant changes to the Charity's operations or risk profile

14. Related Policies and Documents

This policy should be read in conjunction with:

- Anti-Money Laundering Policy
- Conflict of Interest Policy
- Whistleblowing Policy
- Due Diligence Policy
- Partner Selection Due Diligence Policy
- Internal Financial Controls Policy
- Trustee Code of Conduct

15. Regulatory Guidance and References

UK Government

- Bribery Act 2010
- Ministry of Justice Guidance on the Bribery Act 2010

Charity Commission

- Protecting Charities from Harm: Compliance Toolkit
- Reporting Serious Incidents
- Internal Financial Controls for Charities (CC8)

Other Resources

- Transparency International UK (www.transparency.org.uk)
- Action Fraud (www.actionfraud.police.uk)

16. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

17. Trustee Declaration

We, the undersigned trustees of Gloucester Zakat Charity, confirm that we have read, understood, and approved this Anti-Bribery Policy and commit to its implementation.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

— End of Policy —